The Germans had struggled over the years with their colonies. The local groups living on their African territory resisted enforced labor and taxation. In 1888, the Germans were almost expelled from the territory due to their meddling. Nearly ten years later, when the land seemed conquered, they still struggled with government centers and small military fortresses. In 1905, there was an uprising in the area and it was suppressed by German soldiers who were forced to use machine guns. For the next few years, the struggle continued with armed intervention.

Belgium called their colony Congo Free State, which meant that those residing in the region only followed the orders of King Leopold II. The treatment of the locals was extremely harsh and other powers suggested that the king control the work done in the territory. After some years, the area was annexed as another Belgian Colony.

On the other hand, the British controlled their colonies by what is called “indirect rule.” This meant that they identified local power holders and encouraged them to govern in favor of the British Empire. The British colonies were split into provinces or states that were governed by provincial commissioners. They were further divided into districts that were led by district commissioners. Laws, policies on taxation, mining and agricultural production were popular subjects of discussion in London. Then, when a decision was made, laws or policies were passed to the lower colonial administrative levels for enforcement.

The European powers paid a great deal of attention to the economics of colonization. They acquired land, forced labor, introduced cash crops, changed trading patterns and added foreign laborers, all to have a positive impact on the bottom line. Africa became a great source of raw material for the European industry. Eventually, the colonial powers abolished slavery, developed infrastructure and improved both education and healthcare.